

Day 19 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: National Renaissance; Early Uprising Against British Rule

READING MATERIAL

Fourth topic of Unit III, covering 19th-century reform movements and the earliest organized resistance to British rule (pre-1857). Real exam evidence favors founder-attribution and chronological-ordering questions.

- Q:** Real exam: Arrange chronologically — Civil Disobedience Movement, Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion.
A: South Indian Rebellion → Vellore Mutiny (1806) → Sepoy Mutiny (1857) → Civil Disobedience Movement (1930) — in that chronological order.
- Q:** Real exam: Who said his idea was to establish 'a worship of the heart and not of the hand, a sacrifice of the self and not of the possessions of the self'?
A: Raja Ram Mohan Roy.
- Q:** Who founded the Brahmo Sabha (later Brahmo Samaj), and what was he popularly called?
A: Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded it (1828, Calcutta). He is popularly called the 'Morning Star of India' — often regarded as the father of the Indian Renaissance.
- Q:** What were Brahmo Samaj's core positions — and what is a common MIS-statement about it to watch for?
A: Brahmo Samaj rejected polytheism, idol worship, and divine incarnations, and condemned the caste system and superstitions. Watch the trap: Brahmo Samaj did NOT oppose widow remarriage — it actually supported social reforms including widow remarriage; any statement claiming it 'opposed' widow remarriage is false.
- Q:** In what year was Sati (widow immolation) formally abolished by Act, and who founded the Arya Samaj?
A: Sati was abolished in 1829 (under Lord William Bentinck, with Raja Ram Mohan Roy's strong support). Arya Samaj was founded in 1875 by Swami Dayananda Saraswati.
- Q:** What was Dayananda Saraswati's famous slogan, and which book did he write?
A: 'Go back to the Vedas.' He wrote Satyarth Prakash.
- Q:** Who founded the Ramakrishna Mission, and when?
A: Swami Vivekananda, in 1897.
- Q:** Who passed the Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act of 1856 — and what's worth double-checking about this fact?
A: One source attributes it to Lord Dalhousie, but the Act was actually passed (26 July 1856) after Dalhousie's term as Governor-General had ended (Feb 1856) — Lord Canning had already taken over. Treat 'Canning' as the more historically defensible answer, but be aware some TNPSC-prep material states 'Dalhousie' instead.
- Q:** What did T.B. Macaulay intend to create through English education in India?
A: A class of people 'Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, opinion, morals, and intellect' — i.e., an English-educated Indian elite to help administer British rule.
- Q:** What role did Christian missionaries play in modern Indian education?
A: They were among the earliest providers of modern education in India, AND they gave educational opportunities to underprivileged sections who were denied traditional (caste-restricted) learning — both statements are true.
- Q:** What was the Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, who led it, and what did it protest?
A: Led by Mahadev Govind Ranade, it awakened political consciousness among people and protested the Vernacular Press Act of 1878. (It did NOT publish the Amrita Bazar Patrika — that's a false statement to watch for.)
- Q:** Who founded the Deccan Education Society, and who established the Hindu Dharma Pravardhini Sabha (and when)?
A: Deccan Education Society — G.G. Agarkar. Hindu Dharma Pravardhini Sabha — Madan Mohan Malaviya, 1906.
- Q:** What was the first political challenge taken up by the Women's India Association?
A: The right to vote.
- Q:** What social evil did British administrators Colonel Todd, Duncan, and Malcolm discuss and act against?
A: Female infanticide.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Arrange chronologically (earliest first): Sepoy Mutiny, Civil Disobedience Movement, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion.

A. South Indian Rebellion, Vellore Mutiny, Sepoy Mutiny, Civil Disobedience Movement ✓

B. Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion, Sepoy Mutiny, Civil Disobedience Movement

C. Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion, Civil Disobedience Movement

D. Civil Disobedience Movement, Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion

Explanation: South Indian Rebellion → Vellore Mutiny (1806) → Sepoy Mutiny (1857) → Civil Disobedience Movement (1930). [hard, question-bank-2025]

2. Who said his goal was 'a worship of the heart and not of the hand, a sacrifice of the self and not of the possessions of the self'?

A. Swami Dayananda Saraswati

B. Swami Vivekananda

C. Raja Ram Mohan Roy ✓

D. Maharishi Devendranath Tagore

Explanation: Raja Ram Mohan Roy. [hard, question-bank-2026]

3. Raja Ram Mohan Roy, founder of the Brahmo Sabha, is popularly known as the:

A. Father of the Nation

B. Morning Star of India ✓

C. Grand Old Man of India

D. Lokmanya

Explanation: Morning Star of India. [medium, web-research]

4. Which of the following did Brahmo Samaj actually OPPOSE or REJECT?

A. Widow remarriage

B. Idol worship and polytheism ✓

C. Social reform in general

D. Women's education

Explanation: Idol worship/polytheism — Brahmo Samaj supported widow remarriage and social reform, it didn't oppose them. [medium, web-research]

5. Sati was formally abolished by Act in which year?

A. 1825

B. 1827

C. 1829 ✓

D. 1856

Explanation: 1829. [medium, web-research]

6. Arya Samaj's famous slogan, coined by its founder Swami Dayananda Saraswati, was:

A. Swaraj is my birthright

B. Go back to the Vedas ✓

C. Unity in diversity

D. Simple living, high thinking

Explanation: Go back to the Vedas. [easy, web-research]

7. The Ramakrishna Mission was founded in 1897 by:

A. Ramakrishna Paramahansa

B. Dayananda Saraswati

C. Swami Vivekananda ✓

D. Sri Aurobindo

Explanation: Swami Vivekananda. [easy, web-research]

8. T.B. Macaulay's vision for English education in India aimed to create a class of people who were:

A. Fluent only in Sanskrit and Persian

B. Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, opinion, morals and intellect ✓

C. Trained exclusively for military service

D. Focused solely on religious education

Explanation: Macaulay's well-known formulation. [medium, web-research]

9. The Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, led by M.G. Ranade, protested which legislative act in 1878?

A. The Vernacular Press Act ✓

B. The Arms Act

C. The Ilbert Bill

D. The Rowlatt Act

Explanation: The Vernacular Press Act, 1878. [medium, web-research]

10. The first political challenge taken up by the Women's India Association was the right to:

A. Property

B. Education

C. Re-marriage

D. Vote ✓

Explanation: The right to vote. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Highest Common Factor (HCF)

READING MATERIAL

HCF is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence (4 confirmed hits across 2022/2024/2025) shows TNPSC favors HCF *application* problems — measuring/tiling/container word problems and the HCF-LCM relationship — over plain 'find the HCF of these two numbers' questions, so the reading below leads with those application shapes.

Q: Real exam (2025): Two numbers are in the ratio 15:11. If their HCF is 13, find the numbers.

A: When two numbers are in a given ratio, write them as $15k$ and $11k$. Since $\text{HCF}(15,11)=1$ (the ratio is already in lowest terms), k IS the HCF — so $k=13$. The numbers are $15 \times 13=195$ and $11 \times 13=143$.

Q: Real exam (2025): What is the least number of square tiles needed to pave the ceiling of a room 15m 17cm long and 9m 2cm broad?

A: Convert to one unit: $1517 \text{ cm} \times 902 \text{ cm}$. The LARGEST square tile that exactly fits (no cutting) has a side equal to the HCF of the two dimensions. $\text{HCF}(1517, 902) = 41 \text{ cm}$ (via the Euclidean algorithm: $1517=1 \times 902+615$; $902=1 \times 615+287$; $615=2 \times 287+41$; $287=7 \times 41+0$). Tile area = $41 \times 41 = 1,681 \text{ cm}^2$. Room area = $1517 \times 902 = 1,368,334 \text{ cm}^2$. Number of tiles = $1,368,334 \div 1,681 = 814$.

Q: Real exam (2024): If the HCF of x^3-8y^3 and $x^2-k^2y^2$ is $x+ky$, find k .

A: Factor x^3-8y^3 using $a^3-b^3=(a-b)(a^2+ab+b^2)$ with $a=x$, $b=2y$: $x^3-8y^3 = (x-2y)(x^2+2xy+4y^2)$. Factor $x^2-k^2y^2$ using $a^2-b^2=(a-b)(a+b)$: $x^2-k^2y^2 = (x-ky)(x+ky)$. For ' $x+ky$ ' to be the common factor (HCF) of both, it must match one of the first expression's factors. $(x-2y)$ is the only linear factor available there, so $x+ky$ must equal $x-2y$, giving $k=-2$.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the greatest possible volume of a vessel that can exactly measure the milk in cans of 80, 100, and 120 litres (each can measured to full capacity only)?

A: This is asking for the HCF of 80, 100, and 120. $\text{HCF}(80,100)=20$, then $\text{HCF}(20,120)=20$. So the answer is 20 litres — the largest vessel that can measure each can's full volume an exact whole number of times.

Q: Real exam (2022): The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 16 and 240 respectively. If one number is 48, find the other.

A: Use the relationship: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = \text{product of the two numbers}$. $16 \times 240 = 3,840$. Other number = $3,840 \div 48 = 80$.

Q: Method — finding HCF via the Euclidean algorithm (the fast way for large numbers): What is the HCF of 1517 and 902?

A: Repeatedly divide the larger by the smaller and replace the larger with the remainder, until the remainder is 0 — the last nonzero remainder is the HCF. $1517=1 \times 902+615 \rightarrow 902=1 \times 615+287 \rightarrow 615=2 \times 287+41 \rightarrow 287=7 \times 41+0$. $\text{HCF}=41$. This is the same calculation used in ro2 above — recognize it as the standard fast method rather than listing all factors of both numbers.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Two numbers are in the ratio 21:14. If their HCF is 12, find the larger number.

A. 36 ✓

B. 24

C. 252

D. 168

Explanation: Watch out: 21 and 14 are NOT coprime ($\text{gcd}=7$), so you can't directly multiply them by the HCF. Reduce the ratio first: $21:14 = 3:2$ (coprime). Now apply the HCF: larger = $3 \times 12=36$, smaller = $2 \times 12=24$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the largest square tile that can exactly pave a floor measuring 3m 8cm by 4m 20cm (no cutting).

A. 28 cm ✓

B. 14 cm

C. 56 cm

D. 84 cm

Explanation: Convert to cm: 308 and 420. $\text{HCF}(308,420)$: $420=1 \times 308+112$; $308=2 \times 112+84$; $112=1 \times 84+28$; $84=3 \times 28+0$. $\text{HCF}=28 \text{ cm}$. [hard, authored]

3. If the HCF of a^2-4b^2 and $a^2+ab-6b^2$ is $a-2b$, this is consistent with which factorization of the second expression?

A. $(a+3b)(a-2b)$ ✓

B. $(a-3b)(a+2b)$

C. $(a+3b)(a+2b)$

D. $(a-3b)(a-2b)$

Explanation: $a^2-4b^2=(a-2b)(a+2b)$. The second expression factors as $(a+3b)(a-2b) = a^2+ab-6b^2$ — sharing the common factor $(a-2b)$, so that's the HCF. [hard, authored]

4. What is the greatest volume that can exactly measure the contents of drums holding 72, 96, and 120 litres?

A. 12 litres

B. 24 litres ✓

C. 8 litres

D. 6 litres

Explanation: $\text{HCF}(72, 96) = 24$, then $\text{HCF}(24, 120) = 24$. Answer: 24 litres. [medium, authored]

5. The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 12 and 180 respectively. If one number is 36, find the other.

A. 48

B. 54

C. 60 ✓

D. 72

Explanation: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = 12 \times 180 = 2,160$. Other number = $2,160 \div 36 = 60$. [medium, authored]

6. Using the Euclidean algorithm, find the HCF of 1,073 and 925.

A. 37 ✓

B. 29

C. 31

D. 43

Explanation: $1073 = 1 \times 925 + 148$; $925 = 6 \times 148 + 37$; $148 = 4 \times 37 + 0$. $\text{HCF} = 37$. [medium, authored]

7. Two numbers are in the ratio 8:9 and their HCF is 7. Find their sum.

A. 105

B. 119 ✓

C. 126

D. 112

Explanation: Numbers: $8 \times 7 = 56$ and $9 \times 7 = 63$. Sum = $56 + 63 = 119$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Nature, the Gentlest Mother" — Emily Dickinson

READING MATERIAL

A poem personifying Nature as a patient, caring mother who gently disciplines her 'children' (plants, animals, the natural world). Real coaching-site evidence tests personification examples and the poem's caring/patient tone heavily.

Q: Who wrote "Nature, the Gentlest Mother", and what is its central theme?

A: Emily Dickinson. Central theme: Nature personified as an infinitely patient, caring mother — looking after all her 'children' (plants, animals, the natural world) with gentle, unbiased compassion, regardless of their shortcomings.

Q: How is Nature's temperament described in the poem?

A: Gentle and patient — not harsh, angry, cold, or distant.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Nature, the gentlest mother."

A: Personification — Nature (an abstract/non-human concept) is directly given the human role and qualities of a 'mother'. This is the poem's primary, sustained device throughout.

Q: What does "Her admonition mild" suggest about how Nature corrects wrongdoing?

A: Nature gently corrects — not through scolding, anger, or punishment, but mild, patient guidance.

Q: How does Nature 'discipline' her creatures, per the poem's examples?

A: By 'restraining' an overly active ('Rampant') squirrel, or muffling a 'too impetuous' bird — Nature's discipline is gentle moderation, not harsh punishment, shown through small natural behaviours rather than dramatic intervention.

Q: Who is said to hear Nature's 'conversation' on a summer afternoon, and what figure of speech appears in "Her golden finger on her lip"?

A: Travellers hear it. "Her golden finger on her lip" is Personification — Nature given the human gesture of placing a finger to the lips (a 'hush' gesture), continuing the maternal personification.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Nature, the Gentlest Mother" was written by:

- A. Maya Angelou
- B. Robert Frost
- C. Emily Dickinson ✓**
- D. Sarojini Naidu

Explanation: Emily Dickinson. [easy, web-research]

2. How is Nature described in the poem?

- A. Harsh and angry
- B. Gentle and patient ✓**
- C. Cold and distant
- D. Loud and wild

Explanation: Gentle and patient. [easy, web-research]

3. "Nature, the gentlest mother" is an example of which figure of speech?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor
- C. Personification ✓**
- D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — Nature given the role of a mother. [easy, web-research]

4. "Her admonition mild" suggests that Nature:

- A. Scolds angrily
- B. Ignores wrongdoing entirely
- C. Gently corrects ✓**
- D. Punishes severely

Explanation: Gently corrects. [medium, web-research]

5. According to the poem, who hears Nature's 'conversation' on a summer afternoon?

A. Teachers

B. Scientists

C. Travellers ✓

D. Soldiers

Explanation: Travellers. [medium, web-research]

6. "Her golden finger on her lip" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Personification ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — a human 'hush' gesture given to Nature. [medium, web-research]